SafeSpace: Task 18 Usability Preparation

Owner: Layla Donia | Prep deadline: November 13, 2026 | Sessions: November 16-19, 2026

Scope and readiness

Evaluate whether adults can create an assessment, understand the Task 11 palette wording, and reopen/delete saved data. This is not validation of room safety, clinical benefit, or region contrast. Run only on a build with the reviewed Task 11 wording and working save/reopen/delete. Record the commit, device and OS. Recruitment is not complete until at least five real participants explicitly accept a date, time and location.

Participants and session setup

Recruit at least five adults, prioritizing family/unpaid/professional caregivers. Record caregiver or proxy status; do not describe classmates as caregivers unless they are. Seek two additional backups if feasible. This small formative round does not replace any separate course requirement for a larger study. Follow instructor/university requirements before recruitment or collection; this packet is not ethics approval.

Plan 30 minutes: introduction/permission 3; Task 1 up to 5; Task 2 up to 6; Task 3 up to 5; SUS 3; interview/wrap-up 5; transition 3. Use the same test build, photo, starting state and task order for everyone. Allow setup/reset time between appointments. Use a supplied indoor photo without people or private information; no personal photo library or cloud account is required.

Moderator opening - read aloud

Thank you for helping us test SafeSpace. We are testing the app, not you. Participation is voluntary. You may skip an activity or stop at any time. We will note what happens using a participant code, not your name. Please say what you are looking for and what you expect as you work. This prototype describes colors in photographs; it does not establish that a room is safe. We will use supplied test photos. May we proceed?

Log permission to participate. Do not record audio/video/screens without separate explicit permission. Keep scheduling contacts separate from coded responses, restrict access to the team, and set a deletion date under the approved course policy before collection. Do not request patient details.

Moderator rules

Do not explain template categories or show example answers before Task 2. Read participant prompts only, not the success rubric. Use neutral prompts such as "What are you thinking?" or "What did you expect?" Log navigational hints separately; a reminder to think aloud is not a hint. Stop at the task limit or if the participant wants to stop. Record not completed rather than forcing success.

Three task scripts

Task 1 - Create a room assessment

Participant prompt: "You want to keep a color review for a room you are helping look after. Using the supplied room photo, create a room called Practice Room and keep an analysis that you can return to later. Tell me when you believe it is saved."

Starting state: room list on a clean test profile; designated photo available locally. Limit: 5 minutes. Success: correct room and one saved assessment, result displayed, participant recognizes completion. Observe navigation, photo selection, save feedback, errors and help. If blocked, open a prepared assessment after marking the task assisted/not completed; do not prevent testing comprehension.

Task 2 - Understand the findings (Task 11)

Participant prompt: "Imagine explaining this result to another person helping look after the room. In your own words, describe the overall colors, the largest color group, and any smaller strong-color group the result mentions. Explain what the percentages refer to. Then tell me what this result does and does not tell you."

Starting state: Task 11 result with overall, dominant and accent sentences plus limitations. Limit: 6 minutes. Choose a fixture that actually produces an accent under share < 0.10 and chroma >= 0.10. If your initial photo does not, choose another during preparation, then keep that fixture fixed. Do not fabricate a finding. If a run lacks the expected accent, log an instrument/setup deviation; do not score absence as participant failure.

Moderator answer key - prepare before sessions: record the exact generated sentences, template IDs, shares, OKLCh values, rounded percentages and JSON source pointers from the frozen assessment. Check IDs/order against the reviewed Findings implementation. Correct interpretation must agree with this actual output, not a generic example. Overall describes photo colors; largest group corresponds to its stored share; the accent describes a small strong-color group, not a detected object or necessarily a connected area; percentages describe eligible photo pixels, not measured wall area. At least one limitation should be understood (lighting/camera affect appearance, palette is not a two-region contrast measurement, or no safety conclusion).

Score six dimensions independently: overall, largest group, accent, percentage meaning, photo-versus-room limitation, palette-versus-contrast/safety limitation. Each: 0 incorrect/no answer, 1 partial, 2 correct; mark setup-related unavailable items N/A. Keep verbatim short quotes and do not reduce everything to a single success number. Ask "What does that sentence mean to you?" if clarification is needed, without correcting until SUS is complete.

Task 3 - Return to and remove saved work

Participant prompt: "You are returning to the review later. Find the assessment you saved and tell me whether it matches what you saw before. You no longer need this practice assessment: remove it while keeping the room."

Starting state: moderator terminates and relaunches the app before handing it back; no reinstall or data reset. Limit: 5 minutes. Success: participant finds the same assessment, sees matching content, deletes only the target assessment, and the room remains. Moderator checks absence after another relaunch. If Task 1 failed, use a prepared clearly identified practice assessment and log the substitution. Do not ask the participant to delete real data.

After the tasks

SUS administration

Give the separate ten-item SUS form once, immediately after all tasks and before discussion, coaching or design explanations. Say "Please answer based on the SafeSpace version you just used. System means SafeSpace. Give your own first impression." Keep the standard item wording and order. Do not add comprehension questions into SUS or combine their scores.

Short closing interview

1. Which sentence or word was hardest to understand?
2. What did you expect that the app did not do?
3. What would you need before using this information in a real caregiving situation?
4. What would you change first?

Observation and reporting

Use observer-log.csv for each task. Independent success = correct goal with no navigational hint; assisted = success after help; not completed = goal not achieved within limit or stopped. Record app/setup failure separately from user difficulty. Record time, hints, misinterpretations, participant quotes, defects and workaround/substitution. Interpret timings as descriptive because tasks include thinking aloud. With five participants, report counts and individual SUS scores/summary, not population or clinical claims.

SUS scoring

For odd items 1,3,5,7,9: contribution = response - 1. For even items 2,4,6,8,10: contribution = 5 - response. Sum all ten contributions and multiply by 2.5. The result is 0-100, not a percentage. Leave a score missing if any item is unanswered rather than inventing a response. The accompanying spreadsheet calculates only complete valid responses.

Prep and recruitment checklist

By November 11: freeze build/fixture, complete the answer key, and send invitations through approved channels. By November 12: run one pilot (not counted among the five main sessions), correct unclear prompts, and confirm available slots. By November 13: lock scripts/form and obtain five explicit acceptances for November 16-19; confirm device/location/time zone and send session details. If fewer than five accept, report the shortfall and continue recruiting; never mark invited people as confirmed.

Recruitment message: "Hi! I am looking for adults to try SafeSpace, our student app for reviewing colors in room photos. We especially welcome caregivers, but other adults can help too. The session takes about 30 minutes on a provided iPhone, uses test photos, and takes place November 16-19. No technical knowledge is needed. Participation is voluntary. Are you interested? Please share which dates/times work for you. We will confirm the location and time zone before booking."

Confirmation message: "Thank you for agreeing to participate. Please confirm: [date], [time and time zone], [location], approximately 30 minutes. We will provide the iPhone and test photos. You may stop at any point. Please reply to confirm or request a different time." Mark confirmed only after an explicit response; do not promise payment unless approved.

Sources and status

Task design: Nielsen Norman Group, Task Scenarios for Usability Testing (2014), https://www.nngroup.com/articles/task-scenarios-usability-testing/ . SUS: John Brooke, SUS - A quick and dirty usability scale; original instrument hosted by AHRQ. Task 11 thresholds and findings are based on the reviewed feature description supplied by the team; verify against the build before sessions. Recruitment status at packet

creation: no participant confirmations supplied. Materials ready; booking pending.